

The with Names & Places

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The rule for 'the' with places depends on the type of name:

- 1 No 'the' — countries, cities, single lakes/mountains, streets (Spain, Rome, Lake Garda, Mount Fuji).
- 2 the — plural or 'united' names, rivers, seas, ranges (the USA, the Thames, the Alps).
- 3 the — names based on a common noun (the White House, the University of Leeds).

Test: 'the University of X' takes 'the'; 'X University' takes none (Oxford University vs the University of Oxford).

At a glance

No article	the
Countries: France, Japan	Plural/united: the USA, the UK, the Netherlands
Cities: Rome, Cairo	Rivers, seas, oceans: the Nile, the Pacific
Single lakes/mountains: Lake Como, Mount Fuji	Ranges: the Alps, the Andes
Streets: Oxford Street	Named with a common noun: the White House, the British Museum

Learning objectives

- Can apply article rules to countries, cities and geography (CEFR B1).
- Can use 'the' with rivers, seas, ranges and plural country names.
- Can handle institution and building names (the ... of ... vs ... University).



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. The with Names & Places · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. My cousin lives in ____ Netherlands.

A. the

B. a

C. —

D. an

2. We took a boat down ____ Amazon.

A. the

B. a

C. —

D. an

3. She's studying in ____ Japan this year.

A. —

B. the

C. a

D. an

4. They climbed ____ Mount Everest.

A. —

B. the

C. a

D. an

5. We hiked in ____ Alps last summer.

A. the

B. —

C. a

D. an

6. The tour includes ____ British Museum.

A. the

B. a

C. —

D. an

7. He flew into ____ Heathrow Airport.

A. —

B. the

C. a

D. an

8. She graduated from ____ University of Cambridge.

A. the

B. a

C. —

D. an

9. Correct this: 'We sailed across Pacific.'

A. We sailed across the Pacific.

B. We sailed across a Pacific.

C. We sailed across Pacific.

D. We sailed across an Pacific.

10. Which type of name takes 'the'?

A. Rivers, seas and mountain ranges.

B. Single cities.

C. Single lakes.

D. Most countries.

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. the** — Plural country names take 'the': 'the Netherlands'.
2. **A. the** — Rivers take 'the': 'the Amazon'.
3. **A. —** — Most countries take no article: 'Japan'.
4. **A. —** — Single mountains take no article: 'Mount Everest'.
5. **A. the** — Mountain ranges take 'the': 'the Alps'.
6. **A. the** — Institutions with a common noun take 'the': 'the British Museum'.
7. **A. —** — Airports named after a place take no article: 'Heathrow Airport'.
8. **A. the** — 'the University of X' takes 'the'.
9. **A. We sailed across the Pacific.** — Oceans take 'the': 'the Pacific'.
10. **A. Rivers, seas and mountain ranges.** — Rivers, seas and ranges take 'the' (the Nile, the Alps).